



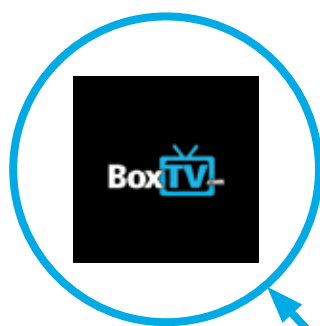
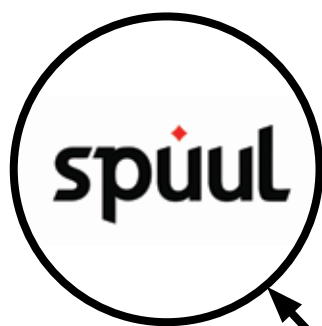
Browse FB on Tor

Facebook's Android app will soon extend support to Tor browser on Android devices. <http://dgit.in/FBOnTor>



Taser's new Pulse

If all you want to do is defend yourself, check out this new less lethal weapon — Pulse from Taser. <http://dgit.in/TaserPulse>



PERFORMANCE

SPUUL

Price: ₹300 per month
Overall Score: 72.4 / 100

Being amongst the oldest streaming services in India, Spuul has often been underrated. The app can do quite well and is amongst the best performers in this test.

That said, while the app has the capacity to perform as well as the best out there, but is too dependent on your Internet speed. Yes, most of these apps are, but many do better than Spuul. On a 2Mbps connection, the app refused to ever launch content on HD and always played catch up when it comes to streaming resolution. Spuul will start at SD quality and then play catch up, eventually reaching 720p. In addition, on both desktop and mobile, Spuul will stutter often while seeking.

On a higher 10Mbps fibre connection though, Spuul does much better. Content streams easily and without stutters, sometimes even if you seek through it.

MAVSHACK

Price: ₹400 per month
Overall Score: 56.7 / 100

One of the lowest performers in this test, Mavshack left us quite disappointed. It costs ₹400 per month, making it the second most expensive in this test, after Netflix. Sadly though, the performance doesn't justify paying that much at all. Mavshack takes almost 17 seconds to launch movies on desktop, while the time can go up to above 25 seconds when you're using the Android app. In this day and age, that's not acceptable and is the opposite of a seamless streaming experience.

Mavshack doesn't stutter too much, but then again, the video quality is almost always in SD, which is a big problem after paying 400 bucks. Even on the 10Mbps connection, Mavshack wasn't able to consistently play content on HD, which was very disappointing. All in all, Mavshack isn't the one we'd recommend to you. It's not worth the money.

BOXTV

Price: ₹199 per month
Overall Score: 58.1 / 100

On the other hand, the lowest performer in our test was BoxTV. We found this one wanting from both streaming and app performance point of views. It can take over six seconds to buffer, when you skip ahead on a movie/show and stutters after that as well. To launch a particular movie or show, BoxTV can take 13 seconds, even on the fastest connection we tried it on, which was a 10Mbps line. It's problems are similar to Mavshack's mentioned above, but BoxTV stutters even more than Mavshack, making it our least favourite.

At ₹199 per month, BoxTV seems to be overpriced and like Mavshack, its performance isn't the only reason we say that. While you can easily binge watch on many of the other streaming services we chose for this test, BoxTV and Mavshack don't really inspire you to do that.

EROS NOW

Price: ₹99 per month
Overall Score: 70.3 / 100

If you haven't heard of Eros Now, you should definitely look it up. This one came as quite a surprise to us. While performance isn't its strongest suit, it's not one to be discounted either. On average, Eros Now takes about 8 seconds to launch a movie, while streaming through to various sections of the movie results in about four to five seconds of buffering. The experience is quite seamless and is complemented by the fact that Eros Now has a pretty vast collection of local content, which we'll talk about later.

The best part about Eros Now though is in the fact that the video quality is absolutely top notch. It's at par with Netflix and ahead of both Hotstar and Spuul. While streaming, Eros Now is able to play on high resolutions consistently and with its lowest HD Streaming pack costing only ₹99, it comes out to be a pretty great deal.

Performance = 72.4

Video load time (wired)..... 14.4 sec
Video load time (mobile)..... 6 sec
Stutter free performance..... 8.8/10
CPU usage..... 16.9%
RAM usage..... 410.8 MB
Video quality..... 5/10

Performance = 55.7

Video load time (wired)..... 16.8 sec
Video load time (mobile)..... 28 sec
Stutter free performance..... 9.6/10
CPU usage..... 12.3%
RAM usage..... 403.3 MB
Video quality..... 5.5/10

Performance = 54.2

Video load time (wired)..... 12.8 sec
Video load time (mobile)..... 16 sec
Stutter free performance..... 8.8/10
CPU usage..... 16.8%
RAM usage..... 401.8 MB
Video quality..... 4/10

Performance = 67.6

Video load time (wired)..... 9.4 sec
Video load time (mobile)..... 6 sec
Stutter free performance..... 10/10
CPU usage..... 17.1%
RAM usage..... 405.1 MB
Video quality..... 9/10